

Jira & Xray

Work and test management with traceability across requirements, tests, executions and defects.

Jira

Jira is a work-management platform for backlog, stories, tasks, bugs, workflows, boards and dashboards. QA uses it to make requirements, defects, evidence, dependencies and status visible to the team.

Official site and documentation

Use the official Jira & Xray source as the primary reference: <https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira>. Official documentation should be the first source for installation, supported versions, syntax changes and new features.

Xray

Xray adds Test Management capabilities to Jira, including Test, Precondition, Test Set, Test Plan and Test Execution concepts.

QA flow

Stories link to tests; executions capture results; defects document failures; plans and reports support traceability and status.

Test Plan vs Test Execution

A Test Plan organizes test scope/planning; Test Execution represents a concrete run in a specific build/environment/context.

Dashboards and metrics

Use filters and dashboards to communicate progress, failures, blockers and risk. Do not use bug count as individual productivity.

Good practices

Standardize titles, environments, evidence, steps and criteria while avoiding unnecessary bureaucracy.

What it is and where it fits

Jira & Xray is a tool or technology that can support Quality Engineering work. Before adopting it, understand the problem it solves, where it fits in the workflow and what evidence or productivity gain it should provide.

How to start safely

Start from the official Jira & Xray site and documentation. Confirm prerequisites, supported versions, operating system and required permissions. Learn in a controlled environment before using it in a critical workflow.

First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in Jira & Xray, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

Using it in a real project

Define where Jira & Xray fits, who owns configuration, how credentials and data are handled and how results are shared. Integrate it into the team workflow instead of creating an isolated activity.

Adoption good practices

Standardize versions and configuration, document important decisions, keep secrets out of code and preserve reproducible examples. Reassess whether Jira & Xray still delivers value as the product evolves.

Common issues and troubleshooting

When Jira & Xray fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.